QUICK START

Find your auction

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Count the right points

HCP A = 4 K = 3 Q = 2 J = 1.
10 through 2 = 0. Count every suit.

Before a fit TP = HCP + 1 for each card beyond four in each suit.

Raising partner's major With 3+ trumps opposite five, replace length points with side-suit shortness: void +5, singleton +3, doubleton +1.

Dummy points HCP + shortness points. Do not also add length points or count shortness in trumps. Discount unsupported honours in short suits.

Minor-opening responses Use HCP + length points; do not add dummy points.

Notrump Use HCP for openings and balanced raises. Useful length may help a long-suit response; shortness does not.

Takeout doubles Judge HCP, shortness in their suit and support for unbid suits together. SAYC has no fixed shortness-point formula.

Combined strength Add your count to partner's estimated count. A range labelled HCP means HCP only.

Follow the branches

Start with the auction situation, then follow indented conditions to the bold action. Use uncontested meanings unless a competitive section applies. An unpassed hand's new-suit response is normally forcing.

Point ranges are guides: consider suit quality, fit, controls and vulnerability. Optional and supplementary treatments require partnership agreement.

SECTION 1

Opening bids

Nobody has opened. Check direct notrump ranges first, then strength, shape and preempts.

Read in order

Balanced notrump openings may include a five-card Major or Minor. About 13+ TP is a one-level opening guide. Length points alone do not rule out a weak two or preempt; borderline hands require judgment.

1 Balanced in a direct NT range?

- ↳ 15–17 HCP ⟶ **Bid 1NT**
- ↳ 20–21 HCP ⟶ **Bid 2NT**
- ↳ 25–27 HCP ⟶ **Bid 3NT (Strong, balanced)**

2 22+ HCP or equivalent playing strength?

- ↳ Bid 2♣ (Artificial, forcing; not always game-forcing)
- ↳ Balanced 22–24 HCP ⟶ **Rebid 2NT after a 2♢ response; this rebid is not forcing**

3 Normal one-level strength?

- ↳ 5+ card Major with no longer Minor ⟶ **Open your longer Major; with equal lengths, open 1♠**
- ↳ Longer Minor with a 5-card Major ⟶ **Normally open the longer Minor, planning natural rebids**
- ↳ No 5-card Major ⟶ **Open your longer Minor**
  - ↳ Equal Minor lengths of 4+ ⟶ **Open 1♢**
  - ↳ 3–3 in Minors ⟶ **Open 1♣**
- ↳ Majors normally require 5+ cards in all seats; judgment may justify an occasional 4-card Major opening in third seat
- ↳ Balanced hand outside direct Notrump ranges
  - ↳ 12–14 HCP with opening strength ⟶ **Open a suit; normally rebid 1NT if no fit or suitable 1-level suit rebid is available**
  - ↳ 18–19 HCP ⟶ **Open a suit; normally jump rebid 2NT if no fit is found**

4 Below one-level strength?

- ↳ Reasonable 6-card suit and 5–11 HCP ⟶ **Open a Weak Two (2♢, 2♡, or 2♠)**
  - ↳ Rarely, an excellent 5-card suit or a poor 7-card suit unsuitable for a 3-level opening may qualify
- ↳ Good 7-card suit ⟶ **Consider a 3-level preempt**
- ↳ Longer suit ⟶ **Consider a higher preempt using playing strength and vulnerability**
- ↳ Suit length alone does not justify a 5-, 6-, or 7-level opening

5 No suitable opening?

Pass.

SECTION 2A

Respond to a suit opening

No interference. Count support points for major raises; use HCP for balanced notrump bids.

Partner opened 1♡ or 1♠

- 0–5 TP ⟶ **Pass**
- 3+ trump support ⟶ **Count dummy points**
  - 6–10 TP ⟶ **Simple Raise**
  - 10–11 TP ⟶ **Limit Raise (Invitational)**
  - Borderline 12 TP ⟶ **Use judgment: limit raise with invitational playing strength, or bid a forcing new suit then support with game-going strength**
  - 13+ TP and 4+ support ⟶ **Jacoby 2NT (Game-forcing)**
  - Game values without 4-card support ⟶ **Bid a new suit first, then support partner**
- Weak hand, 5+ trump support and shortness ⟶ **Consider a direct game raise (Preemptive)**
- Strong suit and slam interest ⟶ **Strong jump shift (Game-forcing)**
- No suitable raise
  - 4+ Spades over 1♡ and 6+ TP ⟶ **Bid 1♠**
  - New suit at the 2-level and 10+ TP ⟶ **Bid 2♣ or 2♢ with 4+ cards, or 2♡ with 5+ cards (Forcing one round)**
  - 6–9 TP without a suitable suit response ⟶ **Bid 1NT (Non-forcing)**
  - 15–17 HCP, balanced, with 2-card support ⟶ **Bid 3NT**

Partner opened 1♣ or 1♢

- 0–5 TP ⟶ **Pass**
- 6+ TP and a 4+ card suit available at the 1-level ⟶ **Normally show the longer suit; with equal four-card suits, bid up the line to look for a Major fit**
- No suitable 1-level suit response
  - 10+ TP and a 4+ card new suit ⟶ **Bid the suit at the 2-level (Forcing one round)**
  - Minor support (normally 5+ Clubs or 4+ Diamonds)
    - 6–10 TP ⟶ **Simple Raise**
    - 10–12 TP ⟶ **Limit Raise**
    - Game values ⟶ **Bid a new suit or Notrump; there is no forcing Minor raise**
  - Strong suit and slam interest ⟶ **Strong jump shift (Game-forcing)**
  - Balanced, no 4-card Major
    - 6–10 HCP ⟶ **Bid 1NT**
    - 13–15 HCP ⟶ **Bid 2NT (Game-forcing)**
    - 16–18 HCP ⟶ **Bid 3NT**
    - 11–12 HCP ⟶ **Use a natural suit response or limit raise where available; see the supplementary treatment box for 3–3–3–4 over 1♣. A direct 2NT remains game-forcing**

Supplementary: 3–3–3–4 over 1♣

- 11–12 HCP, exactly 3 Spades, 3 Hearts, 3 Diamonds, and 4 Clubs over 1♣ ⟶ **Supplementary partnership treatment: respond 1♢ on three cards, then invite in Notrump if opener shows a minimum; this exception is not specified in the SAYC booklet**

SECTION 2B

Strong / preempt responses

Partner opened strong 2♣, a weak two or a higher preempt. Choose your response.

Partner opened strong 2♣

- ↳ 5+ card suit and 8+ TP ⟶ **Bid the suit at its cheapest level (Positive, game-forcing)**
- ↳ Balanced 8+ HCP ⟶ **Bid 2NT (Positive, game-forcing)**
- ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Bid 2♢ (Artificial Waiting; may include a strong hand)**
- ↳ After 2♢, opener's suit rebid forces to 3 of their Major or 4 of their Minor; a 2NT rebid may be passed

Weak two | 5–11 HCP, normally six cards

- ↳ Fit ⟶ **Raise to play, using trump length and vulnerability**
- ↳ Enough tricks for 3NT with the other suits stopped ⟶ **Bid 3NT (To play)**
- ↳ Game interest ⟶ **Bid 2NT (Forcing, feature asking; need not be balanced)**
- ↳ 5+ card new suit ⟶ **Bid the suit (Forcing one round)**
- ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Pass**

Partner opened a three-level preempt

- ↳ Enough collective tricks for Game ⟶ **Raise directly to Game**
- ↳ Own suitable suit and values, below game ⟶ **New suit (Forcing)**
- ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Pass**

Partner opened a higher preempt

- ↳ Enough playing strength for a higher contract ⟶ **Bid further**
- ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Pass**

SECTION 2C

Respond to notrump

Partner opened a balanced notrump hand. Choose a major-suit search, an invitation or a final contract.

Partner opened 1NT | 15–17 HCP

- ↳ 4-card Major and invitational or better values, including 5–4 in the Majors ⟶ **Use Stayman (2♣)**
- ↳ Otherwise, 5+ card Major ⟶ **Use Jacoby Transfers, even with a weak hand**
- ↳ Balanced, no Major to investigate
  - ↳ 0–7 HCP ⟶ **Pass**
  - ↳ 8–9 HCP ⟶ **Bid 2NT (Invitational)**
  - ↳ 10–15 HCP ⟶ **Bid 3NT (Game)**
  - ↳ 16–17 HCP ⟶ **Bid 4NT (Quantitative slam invitation)**
    - ↳ Enough strength for slam ⟶ **Place the slam or investigate Aces with Gerber**
- ↳ Weak long Minor ⟶ **Bid 2♠; partner bids 3♣, then Pass with Clubs or correct to 3♢**
- ↳ 6+ card Minor and invitational values ⟶ **Bid 3♣ or 3♢ (Invitational to 3NT)**
- ↳ 6+ card Major and slam interest ⟶ **Bid 3♡ or 3♠**

2NT | 20–21, or strong 22–24 rebid

- ↳ 4-card Major and game values ⟶ **Bid 3♣ (Stayman)**
- ↳ 5+ card Major ⟶ **Bid 3♢ for Hearts or 3♡ for Spades (Jacoby Transfers)**
- ↳ Balanced, no Major to investigate
  - ↳ Below game values ⟶ **Pass**
  - ↳ Game values, no slam interest ⟶ **Bid 3NT**
  - ↳ Slam invitation ⟶ **Bid 4NT (Quantitative)**
- ↳ Check Aces ⟶ **Bid 4♣ (Gerber)**

Partner opened 3NT | 25–27 HCP

- ↳ No slam interest or Major to investigate ⟶ **Pass**
- ↳ 4-card Major ⟶ **Bid 4♣ (Stayman, not Gerber)**
- ↳ 5+ card Major ⟶ **Bid 4♢ for Hearts or 4♡ for Spades (Jacoby Transfers)**

SECTION 3

Notrump continuations

Follow the branch for Stayman or the transfer you have already made.

After Stayman over 1NT

- Opener responds
  - No 4-card Major ⟶ **2♢**
  - 4+ Hearts, including both Majors ⟶ **2♡**
  - 4+ Spades without 4 Hearts ⟶ **2♠**
- Responder has a 4–4 Major fit
  - Invitational values ⟶ **Raise to 3 of the Major**
  - Game values ⟶ **Raise to 4 of the Major**
- No fit, without a 5-card Major
  - Invitational values ⟶ **2NT**
  - Game values ⟶ **3NT**
  - Opener also has 4 Spades after showing Hearts ⟶ **Correct 3NT to 4♠ when responder's auction shows 4 Spades**
- 5–4 in the Majors, no fit shown
  - Invitational values ⟶ **Bid your 5-card Major at the 2-level**
  - Game values ⟶ **Bid your 5-card Major at the 3-level (Forcing)**
- Responder rebids a Minor at the 3-level ⟶ **5+ cards and slam interest**
- Weak hand able to Pass every response ⟶ **Stayman may be used to seek a better partscore**

After a Jacoby Transfer over 1NT

- 2♢ transfers to Hearts; 2♡ transfers to Spades
- Opener normally accepts at the 2-level
  - 17 HCP and 4-card support ⟶ **May jump to the 3-level**
- After normal acceptance, responder chooses
  - Weak hand ⟶ **Pass**
  - Invitational, 5-card Major ⟶ **2NT**
    - Opener has a minimum ⟶ **Pass without 3-card support, or bid 3 of the Major with a fit**
    - Opener has a maximum ⟶ **Bid 3NT without 3-card support, or 4 of the Major with a fit**
  - Invitational, 6+ card Major ⟶ **Raise the Major to 3**
  - Game values, 5-card Major ⟶ **3NT; opener chooses 3NT or 4 of the Major**
  - Game values, 6+ card Major ⟶ **Raise the Major to 4**
  - New suit ⟶ **Natural, game-forcing**
- 5–5 in the Majors with game-forcing values ⟶ **Transfer to Spades, then bid 3♡**

After Stayman or Transfers over 2NT / 3NT

- After 2NT–3♣, opener responds 3♢ without a Major, 3♡ with Hearts, or 3♠ with Spades only
- After 3NT–4♣, opener responds 4♢ without a Major, 4♡ with Hearts, or 4♠ with Spades only
  - Using Stayman over 3NT commits the partnership above 3NT, even when opener denies a Major
- With both Majors ⟶ **Show Hearts first**
- After a transfer ⟶ **Opener bids the requested Major**
- Responder places the contract using combined strength and fit

SECTION 4

Opener's rebids

Continue a force. Pass only when the auction permits it.

After a One-of-a-Suit Opening

Respond to a forcing bid; Pass is available only after a non-forcing response.

- ↳ After a 1-level suit response, balanced with no suitable fit or 1-level suit rebid
  - ↳ 12–14 HCP ⟶ **Rebid 1NT**
  - ↳ 18–19 HCP ⟶ **Rebid 2NT**
- ↳ Minimum, about 13–15 TP ⟶ **Make the cheapest suitable rebid**
  - ↳ Partner made a simple raise ⟶ **Usually Pass**
  - ↳ Support for partner's Major ⟶ **Simple Raise**
  - ↳ Second suit ⟶ **Bid naturally without reversing**
  - ↳ Long original suit ⟶ **Rebid it; normally 6+ cards**
- ↳ Medium, about 16–18 TP ⟶ **Invite or describe extra strength**
  - ↳ Partner made a simple raise ⟶ **Invite game**
  - ↳ Support for partner's suit ⟶ **Jump Raise**
  - ↳ 6+ card original suit ⟶ **Jump Rebid**
  - ↳ Suitable longer first suit and higher-ranking second suit ⟶ **Reverse (Forcing one round)**
- ↳ Maximum, about 19–21 TP ⟶ **Make a strong rebid**
  - ↳ Support or a strong long suit ⟶ **Bid game or make a strong jump rebid**
  - ↳ Second suit ⟶ **Jump Shift (Game-forcing)**
- ↳ Cheap new-suit rebids can include medium strength; they do not always show a minimum
- ↳ Partner made a limit raise ⟶ **Pass with a minimum; bid game with suitable extras**

After Jacoby 2NT

Opener shows shape first; the auction is game-forcing. With both shortness and a strong 5+ card side suit, this guide uses the supplementary partnership agreement of showing the side suit first.

- ↳ Strong 5+ card side suit ⟶ **Bid it at the 4-level**
- ↳ Otherwise, singleton or void ⟶ **Bid that side suit at the 3-level**
- ↳ No shortness or side suit to show
  - ↳ Minimum ⟶ **4 of the agreed Major**
  - ↳ Medium, about 15–17 TP ⟶ **3NT**
  - ↳ Maximum, about 18+ TP ⟶ **3 of the agreed Major**
- ↳ Responder ⟶ **Sign off in game or investigate slam using controls and Blackwood**

After Strong 2♣

- ↳ Positive response ⟶ **Continue to game or slam**
- ↳ Waiting 2♢ response
  - ↳ Balanced 22–24 HCP ⟶ **Rebid 2NT (Non-forcing); use the 2NT response structure**
  - ↳ Long suit ⟶ **Rebid naturally; forces to 3 of opener's Major or 4 of opener's Minor**
- ↳ Responder's new suit ⟶ **Natural and forcing; do not Pass while a force remains**

After a Weak Two

- ↳ Partner bids 2NT ⟶ **Forcing feature inquiry with game interest, even after an opposing bid or double**
  - ↳ Minimum, about 5–8 HCP ⟶ **Rebid your suit**
  - ↳ Maximum, about 9–11 HCP ⟶ **Show an outside Ace or King by bidding that suit**
  - ↳ Maximum without a feature ⟶ **Bid 3NT**
- ↳ Partner bids a new suit (Forcing one round)
  - ↳ 3-card Major support, sometimes a doubleton honour ⟶ **Raise**
  - ↳ No fit, minimum ⟶ **Rebid your suit**
  - ↳ No fit, maximum ⟶ **Show another suit or bid Notrump**
- ↳ Partner raises or bids 3NT ⟶ **To play; normally Pass**

SECTION 5

Responder's second bid

Reevaluate combined strength and shape after opener has rebid.

Choose the contract level

Evaluate combined strength and shape; use HCP for balanced Notrump bids. Point ranges are approximate; assess borderline hands by fit and suit quality.

- ↳ After an initial 1-level suit response, opposite a minimum opener
  - ↳ About 6–9 TP ⟶ **Sign off with Pass, 1NT when available, or 2 of a previously bid suit, where legal**
  - ↳ About 10–11 TP ⟶ **Invite with 2NT or 3 of a previously bid suit**
  - ↳ Game values ⟶ **Bid game or make a forcing bid for more information**
- ↳ Opener showed extras ⟶ **Reevaluate combined strength; a minimum response may now be enough for game**

Forcing bids and continuations

- ↳ After opener rebids a suit
  - ↳ New suit by an unpassed responder ⟶ **Forcing one round**
  - ↳ Fourth suit at the 2-level or higher ⟶ **May be artificial; asks for more information (Forcing one round)**
- ↳ After opener rebids 1NT
  - ↳ New suit at the 2-level without a jump or reverse ⟶ **Non-forcing**
  - ↳ Responder's reverse or jump shift ⟶ **Game-forcing**
- ↳ After an unpassed hand's initial 2-level new-suit response ⟶ **Responder must bid again unless opener reached game**
  - ↳ Preference, 2NT, or a simple rebid can limit the hand
  - ↳ Jump raise of opener's first suit to 3 ⟶ **Game-forcing**
  - ↳ Example: 1♠–2♣; 2♡–2♠ is a non-forcing preference; 1♠–2♣; 2♡–3♠ is game-forcing
- ↳ Passed-hand responses are not automatically forcing; assess the actual auction

SECTION 6

Opponent opened

Choose a natural overcall, takeout double, two-suited action or pass.

Opponent opened one of a suit

- ↳ Balanced 15–18 HCP, preferably with a stopper in opener's suit ⟶ **1NT Overcall**
- ↳ Opening strength, shortness in opponent's suit and support for the unbid suits ⟶ **Takeout Double; judge HCP and shape together**
- ↳ 5–5 or longer in both Majors, 8+ HCP, over a Minor opening ⟶ **Michaels Cuebid**
- ↳ 5–5 or longer in the other Major and a Minor, 10+ HCP, over a Major opening ⟶ **Michaels Cuebid**
- ↳ 5–5 or longer in the two lowest unbid suits ⟶ **Unusual 2NT**
- ↳ Hand suitable for an opening preempt at the same level ⟶ **Weak Jump Overcall; a jump to the two level resembles a weak two, and a jump to the three level resembles a three-level opening**
- ↳ 8–16 HCP with a good 5+ card suit ⟶ **Natural Overcall; a two-level overcall needs a good suit and extra strength**
- ↳ Stronger suit hand than a normal overcall ⟶ **Double first, then bid the suit**

Opponent opened 1NT

- ↳ Strong defensive hand with enough expected tricks to defeat 1NT ⟶ **Penalty Double**
- ↳ Good long suit and enough playing strength ⟶ **Natural 2♣, 2♢, 2♡ or 2♠; otherwise Pass**
- ↳ Optional partnership agreements: Landy uses 2♣ to show both Majors; an agreed unusual 2NT may show both Minors. These replace the natural SAYC treatment and require agreement

Opponent opened a weak two

- ↳ Balanced 16–19 HCP with stopper ⟶ **2NT Overcall**
- ↳ Opening strength, shortness in their suit and support for the unbid suits ⟶ **Takeout Double; judge HCP and shape together**
- ↳ Strong 5+ card suit and suitable playing strength ⟶ **Natural Overcall at the cheapest level**
- ↳ Suitable 5–5 or longer two-suiter ⟶ **Michaels Cuebid; otherwise Pass**

Opponent opened a three-level preempt

- ↳ Opening strength, shortness in their suit and support for the unbid suits ⟶ **Takeout Double**
- ↳ Strong balanced hand with stopper and enough playing strength ⟶ **Consider 3NT**
- ↳ Powerful long suit ⟶ **Natural Overcall**
- ↳ Suitable 5–5 or longer two-suiter ⟶ **Michaels Cuebid; otherwise Pass**

Opponent opened a higher preempt

- ↳ Double of an opening 4♣ or 4♢ ⟶ **Takeout**
- ↳ Double of an opening 4♡ or higher ⟶ **Penalty**
- ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Bid naturally with enough playing strength, or Pass**

Two suits already bid?

A cuebid of either opponent suit is natural. See the next pages for responses and balancing.

SECTION 7A

Competitive responses

Partner has entered the auction, or an opponent has overcalled partner.

Responding to Partner's Suit Overcall

- ↳ Support and modest values ⟶ **Simple Raise**
- ↳ Need a forcing inquiry about overcall strength, with or without support ⟶ **Cuebid opener's suit (Forcing one round); overcaller rebids their suit with a minimum and shows extras otherwise**
- ↳ Weak hand with extra trumps ⟶ **Jump Raise or raise to game (Preemptive)**
- ↳ Own good suit ⟶ **New suit (Non-forcing)**
- ↳ Balanced, stopper in opener's suit ⟶ **Bid Notrump naturally**
- ↳ After partner's 1NT overcall ⟶ **Natural responses; 2♣ is Stayman, transfers are not standard SAYC here**

Responding to Partner's Takeout Double

- ↳ Opponent passes ⟶ **Bid, even with zero points; prefer an unbid Major**
  - ↳ About 0–8 points ⟶ **Best unbid suit at the cheapest level**
  - ↳ About 9–11 points ⟶ **Jump in an unbid suit (Invitational)**
  - ↳ Game values ⟶ **Bid game or cuebid opener's suit to force**
  - ↳ Balanced with stopper ⟶ **1NT with 6–10 HCP, 2NT with 11–12 HCP, or 3NT with game values**
  - ↳ Strong holding in opener's suit ⟶ **May Pass to convert the double to penalties**
- ↳ Opponent bids ⟶ **No obligation to respond; bidding voluntarily shows values**
- ↳ Doubler after a minimum suit response
  - ↳ Minimum ⟶ **Pass**
  - ↳ Extra strength and support ⟶ **Raise or jump raise**
  - ↳ New suit ⟶ **Strong hand beyond a normal suit overcall**

Partner Opened, Opponent Overcalled

- ↳ Suitable new suit and enough strength ⟶ **Bid naturally (Forcing by an unpassed hand)**
- ↳ At least 4 cards in an unbid Major, without a suitable natural suit bid ⟶ **Negative Double, through 2♠**
  - ↳ 1-level overcall ⟶ **Usually 6+ points, with the 5-card Heart exception below**
  - ↳ 2-level overcall ⟶ **Usually 8+ points**
  - ↳ 1♣ opening, 1♢ overcall ⟶ **Double shows at least 4 cards in each Major**
  - ↳ Minor opening, 1♡ overcall ⟶ **Double shows exactly 4 Spades; 1♠ shows 5+**
  - ↳ Minor opening, 1♠ overcall ⟶ **Double shows 4 Hearts and 6+ points, or 5 Hearts and 5–10 points; direct 2♡ shows 5+ Hearts and 11+ points**
- ↳ Support and 6–10 TP ⟶ **Simple Raise**
- ↳ Support and invitational values ⟶ **Jump Raise: 10–11 dummy points for a Major, 10–12 TP for a Minor**
- ↳ Game-forcing values without a clear natural direction ⟶ **Cuebid opponent's suit; usually a raise, but support is not required**
- ↳ Balanced with stopper ⟶ **Natural Notrump response**
- ↳ Penalty holding in opponent's suit ⟶ **Pass; opener may reopen with a takeout double**
- ↳ Opener after a Negative Double ⟶ **Bid a shown suit with a minimum or show extras with a stronger rebid**

SECTION 7B

Interference / balancing

Apply the specific exception before the general rule that interference cancels a convention.

Opponent Doubled Partner's Suit Opening

- ↳ 1-level new suit ⟶ **Forcing, unlimited**
- ↳ 2-level non-jump new suit ⟶ **Non-forcing, 6–10 points, usually a 6-card suit**
- ↳ Jump Shift ⟶ **Weak, 6+ card suit, to play**
- ↳ Good support, normally 4+ cards, and 10+ TP ⟶ **2NT (Limit raise or better)**
- ↳ 10+ HCP without a better descriptive bid ⟶ **Redouble**
- ↳ Weak hand with good support ⟶ **Preemptive Jump Raise**

Redoubles

- ↳ Opponent made a takeout double ⟶ **Shows strength**
- ↳ Own suit contract doubled for penalty at the 3-level or below ⟶ **SOS; asks partner to choose another suit and shows support for at least 2 unbid suits**
- ↳ Own contract at the 4-level or higher, or opponent doubled a conventional bid ⟶ **To play**

Balancing / Reopening

Opponent's opening followed by two Passes; your Pass would end the auction.

- ↳ Suitable shape ⟶ **Reopen with a suit bid or takeout double; may be lighter than a direct action**
- ↳ Balanced 10–15 HCP ⟶ **Reopen 1NT**
- ↳ No suitable action ⟶ **Pass**
- ↳ Partner ⟶ **Allow for lighter balancing strength when responding**

Interference over Partner's 1NT

- ↳ Opponent doubles ⟶ **Stayman and transfers remain on**
- ↳ Opponent bids a suit ⟶ **Stayman and transfers are off**
  - ↳ Own suit ⟶ **Natural**
  - ↳ Game-forcing values and Major interest ⟶ **Cuebid opponent's suit as a substitute for Stayman**
- ↳ Opponent doubles a transfer
  - ↳ Opener has a real fit ⟶ **Complete the transfer voluntarily**
  - ↳ Only 2-card support ⟶ **May Pass; responder can bid their Major**
  - ↳ Good holding in the doubled suit ⟶ **Redouble to play**
- ↳ Opponent interferes after a conventional response ⟶ **Retain its meaning where possible; voluntary bids show a real fit**

Other Interference

- ↳ Non-competitive conventions normally stop applying after an opponent's bid or double unless specifically retained
- ↳ Partner opened a weak two ⟶ **The forcing 2NT feature inquiry remains on after an opponent's bid or double**

Two-Suited Overcalls

- ↳ Partner used Michaels over a Major ⟶ **2NT asks for the unspecified Minor**
- ↳ Partner used Michaels or Unusual 2NT ⟶ **Prefer a shown suit; raise with fit, or explore game with strength**
- ↳ Opponent used Michaels or Unusual 2NT
  - ↳ 10+ points and defensive interest ⟶ **Double**
  - ↳ Game-forcing values ⟶ **Cuebid a suit they showed**
  - ↳ Otherwise ⟶ **Bid naturally or Pass**
- ↳ Opponents have already bid two suits ⟶ **A cuebid of either is natural, not Michaels**

SECTION 8

Slam decisions

Check playing strength, controls and a safe stopping place before asking for aces.

Slam No Trump

- ↳ Slam interest ⟶ **Evaluate combined strength; about 33 HCP is a small-slam guide**
- ↳ Partner's natural 1NT or 2NT opening or rebid
  - ↳ Invite based on strength ⟶ **Bid 4NT (Quantitative; partner accepts with a maximum)**
  - ↳ Check Aces ⟶ **Bid 4♣ (Gerber)**
    - ↳ 4♢ ⟶ **0 or 4 Aces**
    - ↳ 4♡ ⟶ **1 Ace**
    - ↳ 4♠ ⟶ **2 Aces**
    - ↳ 4NT ⟶ **3 Aces**
- ↳ Partner opened 3NT ⟶ **4♣ is Stayman, not Gerber**

Slam Trump Suit

- ↳ Agreed trump suit and slam interest ⟶ **Evaluate playing strength and controls; 33 TP is a guide, not a requirement**
- ↳ Control bidding ⟶ **Bid a side suit to show a control while exploring slam in the agreed trump suit**
- ↳ No agreed trump suit ⟶ **Do not assume 4NT is Blackwood**
- ↳ Agreed trump suit and enough strength
  - ↳ Void or two quick losers in a side suit ⟶ **Prefer control bidding to Blackwood**
  - ↳ Before Blackwood ⟶ **Make sure an unfavourable response still leaves a safe stopping place; a response above 5 of your minor may already force you too high**
  - ↳ Check Aces ⟶ **Bid 4NT (Standard Blackwood)**
    - ↳ 5♣ ⟶ **0 or 4 Aces**
    - ↳ 5♢ ⟶ **1 Ace**
    - ↳ 5♡ ⟶ **2 Aces**
    - ↳ 5♠ ⟶ **3 Aces**
- ↳ Missing two Aces or inadequate controls ⟶ **Stop below slam**

King Asking and Grand Slam

- ↳ After Gerber's Ace response, with all four Aces confirmed ⟶ **5♣ asks for Kings**
  - ↳ 5♢ ⟶ **0 or 4 Kings**
  - ↳ 5♡ ⟶ **1 King**
  - ↳ 5♠ ⟶ **2 Kings**
  - ↳ 5NT ⟶ **3 Kings**
- ↳ After Gerber's Ace response, any bid by the asker other than 5♣ ⟶ **To play, including 4NT**
- ↳ After Blackwood, with all four Aces confirmed ⟶ **5NT asks for Kings**
  - ↳ 6♣ ⟶ **0 or 4 Kings**
  - ↳ 6♢ ⟶ **1 King**
  - ↳ 6♡ ⟶ **2 Kings**
  - ↳ 6♠ ⟶ **3 Kings**
- ↳ Jump to 5NT in an agreed suit auction ⟶ **Grand Slam Force, distinct from the Blackwood follow-up**
  - ↳ 2 of the top 3 trump honours ⟶ **Bid 7 of the agreed suit**
  - ↳ Fewer ⟶ **Bid 6 of the agreed suit**
  - ↳ Some nonjump 5NT bids in five-level auctions also carry this meaning; the auction must distinguish them from a Blackwood King ask
- ↳ Opponent bids over Gerber 4♣ or Blackwood 4NT ⟶ **Use DOPI in SAYC**
  - ↳ Double with 0 Aces, Pass with 1, cheapest bid with 2, next bid with 3
- ↳ Opponent doubles the Ace ask ⟶ **ROPI is an optional partnership extension**
  - ↳ If agreed ⟶ **Redouble with 0 Aces, Pass with 1, cheapest bid with 2, next bid with 3**

Contract thresholds

Contract	Combined guide
3NT	25+ HCP
4♡ / 4♠	25+ TP
5♣ / 5♢	28–29+ TP
Small slam (6-level)	33+ HCP in NT; 33+ TP in suits
Grand slam (7-level)	37+ HCP in NT; 37+ TP in suits
Partscore	Below game values: HCP in NT; TP in suits

Typical partscores: 1NT / 2NT; 1–4 of a minor; 1–3 of a major. Suit slams need 12 or 13 tricks and adequate controls; TP alone does not establish this.

SECTION 9

Defensive leads / signals

Standard SAYC carding. Use the auction and visible cards to interpret a signal.

Opening lead

- Touching honours or an interior honour sequence ⟶ **Lead the top of the sequence**
- Against suit contracts, from A–K–x ⟶ **Lead the Ace**
- Leads from length ⟶ **Fourth-best**
  - From 3 small cards against a suit contract ⟶ **Lead the lowest**
  - From 3 small cards against notrump ⟶ **Lead the highest**
  - From 4 or more cards without an honour ⟶ **Lead the second-highest**

Attitude and count

- Following suit or discarding, when attitude applies
  - High card ⟶ **Encourage**
  - Low card ⟶ **Discourage**
- Count signals, when used
  - High then low ⟶ **Even number**
  - Low then high ⟶ **Odd number**
- Signals guide partner; the visible cards and auction still determine the play

GLOSSARY 1 / 2

Shapes / bidding terms

Use these definitions when a branch refers to hand shape, support or the meaning of a call.

Hand and suits

Balanced A 4–3–3–3, 4–4–3–2, or 5–3–3–2 hand.

Controls Aces or voids stop the first round of a suit; Kings or singletons can stop the second round in a suit contract.

Doubleton You have 2 cards in this suit

Fit A suit suitable for trumps, usually with at least eight cards combined between you and partner.

Honours A, K, Q, J, and 10. The top three honours are A, K, and Q.

Major Suit (Major) ♡♠

Minor Suit (Minor) ♣♢

Outside Cards outside of your long suits

Side Suit A suit other than the agreed trump suit.

Singleton You have a single card in a suit

Stopper A holding that can win a trick in a suit before opponents can run it; lower honours need enough small cards for protection.

Suit ♣♢♡♠

Support Cards in partner's suit that help form a trump fit.

Trump The suit whose cards beat cards of other suits. You may play a trump on another suit's lead only when unable to follow suit; the highest trump played wins the trick.

Unbalanced A hand outside the standard balanced shapes.

Void You have no cards in a suit

[X]-Card Suit [X] is number of cards you have in the suit

Contracts

Contract The final bid, specifying the trump suit or Notrump. The bid level plus six is the number of tricks required, so 3NT requires nine tricks.

Game A made contract worth at least 100 trick points, excluding bonuses.

Grand Slam A 7-level contract requiring all 13 tricks.

Notrump (NT) A contract with no trump suit.

Partscore A made contract worth fewer than 100 trick points, excluding bonuses.

Slam Term for attempting to win between 12 and 13 tricks (6-7 bid)

Small Slam A 6-level contract requiring 12 tricks.

Trick One card played by each player; the winning card takes the trick.

Bidding and raising

Artificial You are bidding something which means something else

Forcing Partner must bid again; a one-round force requires one more bid, a game force requires reaching game.

Invitational Asks partner to bid higher with extra strength; partner may Pass.

Jump Raise Raising partner's suit while skipping at least one available level.

Jump Rebid Rebidding your own suit while skipping an available level.

Jump Shift Bidding a new suit while skipping an available level; its strength depends on the auction.

Limit Raise An invitational raise showing support and asking partner to bid game with extra strength.

Natural A bid describing the named suit or a willingness to play Notrump.

Passed Hand A player who passed before partner opened.

Preference Returning to one of partner's suits, sometimes with only limited support.

Raising Bidding partner's suit at a higher level to show support.

Rebid A second bid by the same player.

Reverse Showing a higher-ranking second suit at a level that forces preference to your first suit one level higher.

Sign Off A bid intended to end the auction in the chosen contract.

Simple Raise Raising partner's suit one level.

Up the Line Bidding the lowest available of equally long suits.

GLOSSARY 2 / 2

Competition / conventions

The numbered decision sections give the continuations. Optional methods require agreement.

Competitive bidding

Balancing Bidding after an opening and two Passes, when your Pass would end the auction.

Cooperative Double Asks partner to choose between defending doubled and bidding, by partnership agreement.

Cuebid Bidding a suit an opponent has already bid in

Interference An opponent bids or doubles during your auction.

Negative Double A responder's takeout double after partner opens and an opponent overcalls; usually shows an unbid Major.

Overcall A bid after an opponent's opening.

Penalty Double A double intended to defeat the opponent's contract and increase the penalty.

Preempt A high-level bid with a long suit and limited strength that takes bidding space from opponents.

Psychic Bid A bid that deliberately misrepresents your strength or suit length.

Redouble A call after an opponent doubles; can show strength, be to play, or ask for rescue.

Takeout Double A double asking partner to bid an unbid suit, usually showing opening strength and support for the unbid suits.

Vulnerability The scoring condition that increases game/slam bonuses and penalties for failed contracts.

Weak Jump Overcall (WJO) A jump bid over an opponent's opening, showing a long suit and weak strength.

Weak Two An opening 2♢, 2♡, or 2♠ normally showing a good six-card suit and limited strength; see Section 1 for the occasional length exceptions.

Ace and feature inquiries

Blackwood 4NT in an agreed suit auction asks for Aces.

DOPI After an opponent bids over Gerber 4♣ or Blackwood 4NT: Double with 0 Aces, Pass with 1, cheapest bid with 2, next bid with 3.

Feature Asking 2NT over a weak two asks opener to show an outside Ace or protected King with a maximum hand.

Conventions continued

Fourth Suit Forcing Responder bids the fourth suit at the 2-level or higher to seek more information; in SAYC normally forcing one round.

Gambling 3NT An optional agreement showing a solid 7+ card Minor with little outside strength; SAYC uses a strong balanced 3NT opening.

Gerber 4♣ over a natural 1NT or 2NT opening or rebid asks for Aces.

Grand Slam Force A jump to 5NT asks for a grand slam with 2 of the top 3 trump honours.

Jacoby 2NT A game-forcing 2NT response to a 1♡ or 1♠ opening, showing 4+ trump support and 13+ dummy points.

Jacoby Transfers Over 1NT, bid 2♢ for 5+ Hearts or 2♡ for 5+ Spades; partner bids your Major.

Landy A 2♣ overcall of 1NT showing both Majors, by partnership agreement.

Law of Total Tricks With a fit, combined trump length guides competitive raises; it estimates total tricks available to both sides.

Michaels Cuebid A cuebid of opponent's opening suit showing 5–5 or longer: both Majors over a Minor, or the other Major and a Minor over a Major.

Pass-or-Correct Partner passes with the bid suit or corrects to their actual suit.

Quantitative Slam A 4NT raise of natural notrump invites 6NT; partner accepts with a maximum.

ROPI After Ace asking is doubled: Redouble with 0 Aces, Pass with 1; agreed extension.

SOS Redouble Asks partner to escape a low-level doubled suit contract by choosing another suit.

Stayman Asks for a 4-card Major. Over 1NT: 2♢ denies a Major, 2♡ shows Hearts and may include Spades, 2♠ shows Spades without Hearts.

Unusual 2NT A jump overcall of 2NT showing 5–5 or longer in the two lowest unbid suits.

Based on `bridge-bidding-guide.md`. Official sources: ACBL SAYC System Booklet (revised January 2006), `https://web2.acbl.org/documentLibrary/play/sayc_book.pdf`; SAYC card, `https://web2.acbl.org/documentLibrary/play/sayc_card.pdf`. Evaluation formulas are teaching aids; supplementary treatments are labelled.